Open Source Endowment

Board call
28 March 2025

Agenda

1. Overview
2. Operations
3. Product
4. Fundraising

Roadmap (reminder)

Milestone 0 - Private launch (Mar 2025)

1. The entity is incorporated and can accept donations
2. The endowment is formed and received the first donation

Milestone 1 - Public launch (Sep 2025)

1. The entity has got a tax-exempt status from the IRS
2. Acquired 20-100 co-founding donors for $500-1M total amount
3. Website has the content and is ready to accept donations
4. OSE has formed a diverse well-balanced board (~5 members)
5. Publication on Techcrunch

Milestone 2 - First distribution (Feb 2025)

1. Donor community has strongly grown (2x?) since the public launch
2. Donors helped to refine the algorithm, and we made test distributions
3. First distribution was made using the endowment proceeds (at FOSDEM?)

Overview

Operations	Product	Fundraising
Nonprofit corporation ✅	Base governance model ✅	20-100 co-founding donors ✅
Address & Bank accounts ✅	Board members & advisors ⏳	Logo & basic web presence ⏳
Bylaws & Form 1023 ⏳	Policies: membership, endowment, etc.	$0.5-1M total commitment ⏳
Asset manager	Donors club	Public promotion
Donation tools	Selection & distribution model	Full website
501(c)3 status		Corporate donors

Operations

Done

- Incorporation docs
- Bank account for donations (Mercury)

Formal decision required

- Governance docs: Bylaws, officers & board members, CoI policy → Form 1023
- Other matters: board advisor (Amy Parker), dedicated endowment account (?)

Selection of asset managers

- Endowment experience? Skin in the game? Target returns?
- Board member with a relevant experience
- First candidate – Mercer Advisors

Donation tools

Product

Board development

- Amy Parker (advisor) ✅, Josepha Haden ⛔, need more candidates
- Target experience: fundraising, low-risk public investing, donor networks, etc?

Policies

- Membership
- Endowment
- Conflict of interest
- Gift acceptance

Donors club & grant model

- Quarterly newsletter? Private repo?
- Selection & distribution discussion

Fundraising

Pipeline	11 Feb 2025	27 Mar 2025	Target (Q3 2025)
# Donors committed	14	24	20-100
# Specified amount	7	17	
Total commitment	$232K	$457K	$500K-1M

Median commitment	$5000
Collected to date	$0
Requires 501(c)3	$150,000

Notable new donors:

- Mitchell Hashimoto (Hashicorp)
- Jan Oberhauser (N8N)
- Félix Malfait (Twenty)
- Renee Shah (Amplify Partners)

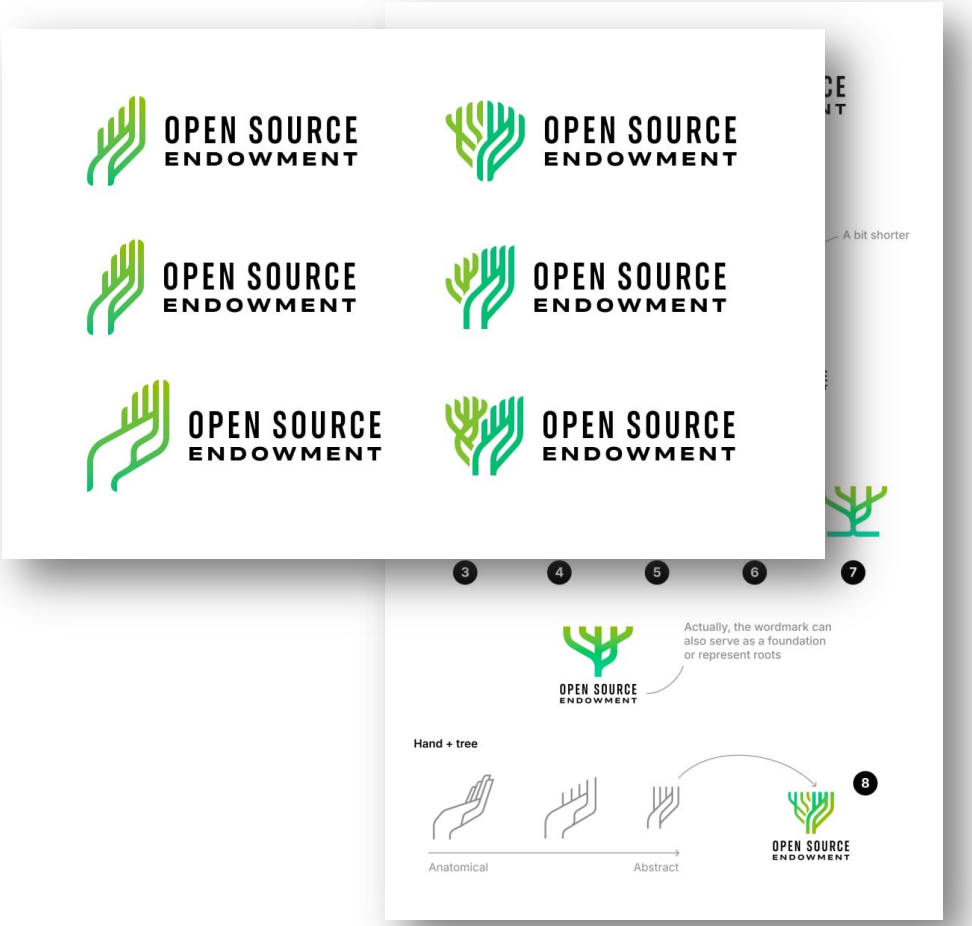
Promising pipeline:

- Shay Banon (Elastic) ~ $1.1B
- Walter Kortchak (Summit Partners) ~ $1.5B
- Andy Konwinski (Databricks, Laude Ventures)

Fundraising

Web presence

- Logo by Evil Martians
- https://github.com/osendowment/foundation – public docs

Public strategy

- Limited “social” launch now?
- Linux Foundation, GitHub
- Landing page, full website